

The Red Hand Beneath the Spire

A Sermon Delivered in Fenspire

Attend, watchful souls of Fenspire. Let the wind worry the stones, and let the stark spire above the Gloaming Reach remind us that height is not holiness. A tower may see far and still fail to see the truth beneath its own shadow.

Today we speak of **Brannoc Ironmere the Red-Handed**.

He was born in **255 AS**, when the wounds of the Sundering had long since hardened into custom. He became a **major Sellsword Captain**, a man carrying the hard, dangerous presence of a seasoned sellsword. No canonical physical features are established for him; no honest tongue may give him a face that history did not grant. His visual identity is the epithet **“the Red-Handed”** and the martial station of a Sellsword Captain.

Yet behind that iron station lay a concealed claim. Brannoc Ironmere the Red-Handed was the **unacknowledged heir to the Bleeding Crown**. Mark this well: a claim may be hidden from the court, denied by the throne, and still burn within the claimant. Blood does not require a herald to remember itself.

But remember this also: concealment is not sanctity. A secret inheritance may be a burden, a temptation, or a blade waiting in the dark. The dangerous presence of Brannoc was not proof that he was righteous. Nor was his silence proof that he was false. We who stand beneath stone and spear must beware the easy sermon that turns a powerful dead man into either saint or devil.

Brannoc died in **300 AS during the Accord of Mournthrone**. There the account ends for the body, but not for the warning. A man may march beneath another banner while carrying a crown inside his ribs. A hand may serve coin, steel, or destiny—and those masters do not always know one another.

Look upon Fenspire. It was founded in **57 AS**. Its silhouette rises stark above the dim character of the **Gloaming Reach**. It is garrisoned, and its garrison is **3,742**. Such vigilance is our daily garment: discipline at the gate, watchfulness upon the wall, suspicion in every oath. But walls do not cleanse ambition. Spears do not make a hidden heir harmless.

Therefore, keep watch over the stranger—and over the claim you conceal from yourself. Let no red hand teach you that power is destiny. Let no crown teach you that blood is virtue. When the spire casts its shadow, stand awake within it.

For the dead cannot answer their names.

The living must.